Universal Human Values — II · 21LEM202T

Unit 1 · Session 2 · SLO 1 — Solved Worksheet

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Unit – 1 : Session – 2 | Understanding Value Education

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

• Q1. 'Value of a unit is its participation in the larger order' — a thing is valuable by the role it plays in the larger whole it belongs to. Examples: a teacher's value lies in the student's development (participation in the larger order of education); water's value is its participation in nourishing plants, animals and soil; a family member's value is their contribution to the family's harmony. Extended to human values: the value of a human being is their participation in the larger order — in family, society and nature — i.e., living with mutually fulfilling behaviour and mutually enriching work. A person who exploits others/nature participates destructively and thus has low human value.

• Q2. Four guidelines for value education: (1) UNIVERSAL — the content must be universal, applicable to all people, all places, all times; not sectarian. (2) RATIONAL — it must be based on reasoning and understanding, not on blind belief, fear or greed. (3) NATURAL & VERIFIABLE — it must be naturally acceptable to the Self and verifiable through one's own living and experience. (4) ALL-ENCOMPASSING — it must cover all dimensions of human living: thought, behaviour, work and realisation; and all levels: individual, family, society and nature.

• Q3. Values = understanding of what is VALUABLE — what to do and why (the 'what'); skills = the technique of HOW to do it. Priority: VALUES first, then skills — values decide the direction, skills provide the power. Complementarity: values without skills remain wishful; skills without values lead to misuse (e.g., technical skill used for weapons, corruption, pollution). Present state of education: it teaches skills almost exclusively (degrees for jobs) and neglects values — producing competence without direction, which shows up as stress, corruption and ecological destruction.